

Industrial Revolution

Emergence of Sociology

What is Industrial Revolution?

The Industrial Revolution was a cultural and economic shift from the cottage industry, traditional agriculture, and manual labor to a system of factory-based manufacturing that included complex machinery, continual technological growth, new energy sources, and developments in transportation.

Industrial Revolution was a period of major industrialization and innovation during the late 1700s and early 1800s. The Industrial Revolution began in Great Britain and quickly spread throughout the world.

How long Did it last?

- The industrial revolution lasted For over 100 years. After beginning in Britain in the late 1700's it spread to Europe and U.S

Phases of Industrial Revolution

The Industrial Revolution can be divided into two phases

1. First industrial revolution

The first wave of the Industrial Revolution lasted from the late 1700s to the mid-1800s. It industrialized the manufacture of textiles and began the move of production from homes to factories. Steam power and the cotton gin played an important role in this period.

Second Industrial Revolution

- The next wave took place from the mid-1800s to the early 1900s. During this phase large factories and companies began to use more technologies to mass produce goods. Important innovations during this period include the use of electricity, the production line, and the Bessemer steel process.
- Samuel Slater is the father of American Industrial Revolution
- He designed 1st textile mill in U.S.

Positive impacts of Industrial Revolution

- High living standard
- More Job Opportunities
- More affordable products
- Competition
- Development of cities

Negative impacts of Industrial Revolution

- Child labour
- Wage slavery
- Slums
- Terrible working conditions
- Increase in the rate of crime

Industrial Revolution and Sociology

- Auguste Comte (1798–1857), widely considered the “father of sociology,” became interested in studying society because of the changes that took place as a result of the French Revolution and the Industrial Revolution.
- People abandoned a life of agriculture and moved to cities to find factory jobs during Industrial Revolution. Comte looked at the extensive changes brought about by the French Revolution and the Industrial Revolution and tried to make sense of them. He felt that the social sciences that existed at the time, including political science and history, couldn’t adequately explain the chaos and upheaval he saw around him. He decided an entirely new science was needed. He called this new science sociology, which comes from the root word socius, a Latin word that means “companion” or “being with others.” Comte decided that to understand society, one had to follow certain procedures, which we know now as the scientific method. The scientific method is the use of systematic and specific procedures to test theories in psychology, the natural sciences, and other fields.